IN DIALOGUE WITH

HUMANITY

COURSE OUTLINE

Dr. Deng Yang-zhou (鄧揚舟 博士)
Email: dengyangzhou@cuhk.edu.cn

A: DESCRIPTION

This course aims at exposing you to some classic writings in topics of humanity, and more important, inspiring some *intellectual reflection* over your own life experience. Themes of the reflection will be orientated into three directions, namely:

Part I: "Self and Human Potential" (*Odyssey - Zhuangzi*);
Part II: "Faith and Human Limitation" (*Heart Sutra-Qur'an*);
Part III: "Self in Social Institutions" (*Waiting for the Dawn-Manuscripts*).

Each week you will meet for two times, one lecture and one interactive seminar. Emphasis will be placed on your capacity to respond critically to the selected texts in oral and written presentations, in the form of class discussions, short write-ups and term papers.

B: TEXTBOOK

All required readings are collected in the textbook, ***In Dialogue with Humanity* (與人文對話), 3rd ed.**, 4th ed. (Hong Kong: Office of University General Education, CUHK, 2013). Some texts are different from the two editions of textbook, and for these texts, prior instructions of selection will be made by the instructor.

C: ASSESSMENT

20% Presentations or Debates (12 %), **Attendance and Engagement** in discussions (8%)
Each time, Presentations and Debates will be assessed by 2 anonymous peer students, together with the teacher. More instructions on the forms of presentations and debates will be provided in due course.
26 % Quizzes (Quiz 1 = 18 %; Quiz 2 = 8 %)
Quiz 1, to be conducted on the second half of the 9th class , will be based on Part I and Part II of textbook 3rd Edition. All questions in this quiz will be in the form of multiple choice. Quiz 2, to be conducted on the last week, will be based on Part III of the textbook. Questions will take the forms of both multiple choice and free response.
Questions on English texts will be in English, and questions on Chinese texts will be drafted bilingually.
24 % Reflective journals (Totally 2 entries, 12% each, 500-700 words in English, or 600-800 Chinese characters)
Every week, on the e-learning platform, i.e. the course Blackboard, a set of questions will be released for the text to be discussed in the following week. Your reflective journals should be a short essay that responds to one of the questions.
You should submit each of your reflective journals before you attend the seminar on the very text you write on.
You need to write 2 reflective journals for two texts from different Parts of the textbook, respectively, and you cannot write the two journals based on two texts within a single Part. Also, you should not write on the text that you present on.
30% Term Paper (1,400–1,800 words in English or 1,600–2200 characters in Chinese).
Guidelines on term paper will be provided in due course.

D: ABSENCE POLICY

Non-excused Absence. You are allowed *only one non-excused absence*. A second non-excused absence will attract a warning letter.
Excused Absence: Either seek your teacher's prior approval, or in the case of illness, bring in a medical certificate afterwards. If there are too many absences (excused or not), *you may probably fail the course*. In such a case, you should discuss with your teacher, to consider either dropping the course or doing some make-up work.

E: ACADEMIC HONESTY

CUHK has a policy of *zero-tolerance* for plagiarism or any other form of academic dishonesty. Students should refer to http://www.cuhk.edu.hk/policy/academichonesty/ for the University policy.
All reflective journals and the term paper will be verified by VeriGuide immediately after your final submission via Moodle.

F: WEEKLY SCHEDULE

Possible changes of the schedule will be informed via emails.

Week	Seminar Content(Mon/Tue)	Lecture Content(Fri)	Remark
1 Sep 2-6	**Course Introduction** (Lecture)	***Odyssey*** (Lecture)	
2 Sep 9-13	***Odyssey*** (Seminar)	***Symposium*** (Lecture)	
3 Sep 16-20			Mid-autumn holidays
4 Sep 23-27	***Symposium*** (Seminar)	***Ethics*** (Lecture)	
5 Sep 30	***Ethics*** (Lecture)		National Holidays. Tutorial for Sep 30 Monday groups.
6 Oct 8-11	***Ethics*** (Lecture)	***Analects*** (Lecture)	Tutorial for Tuesday and Wednesday groups.
7 Oct 14-18	***Analects*** (Seminar)	***Zhuangzi*** (Lecture)	
8 Oct 21-25	***Zhuangzi*** (Seminar)	***Heart Sutra*** (Lecture)	
9 Oct 28- Nov1	***Heart Sutra*** (Seminar)	***Bible*** (Lecture)	
10 Nov 4-8	**Bible** (Seminar)	***Qur'an*** (Lecture)	
11 Nov 11-15	***Qur'an*** (Seminar)	***Reviewing & Quiz***	First Quiz (Part I, II) in lecture.
12 Nov 18-22	***Waiting for the Dawn*** (Seminar)	***Social Contract*** (Lecture)	
13 Nov25-Nov 29	***Social Contract*** (Seminar)	***Wealth of Nations*** (Lecture)	Assignment of Term Paper in seminar
14 Dec 2-6	***Wealth of Nations*** (Seminar)	***Economic and Philosophic Manuscripts*** (Lecture)	
15 Dec 9-13	***Economic and Philosophic Manuscripts*** (Seminar)	**Reviewing & Quiz**	Second Quiz (Part III) in lecture.
16 Dec 2-13	**Term Paper Consultation**		